Preamble

In this document, you'll find several examples of syllabus language about AI. We hope that they're helpful as you consider the AI-relevant policies you'll adopt in your courses. To help you decide how you might choose among them or adapt them to your own purposes, this preamble provides some context about how we are thinking about these example policies.

For the purposes of this document, when we say "AI" we mean computer systems that mimic human intelligence in their outputs. For example, we mean to include chatbots (like ChatGPT) that can generate text that sounds human-written as well as image generators (like DALL-E) that can produce graphics that look human-designed. We also intend to include the large and growing set of tools built on this technology (like the writing aid Grammarly or the citation mapping tool ResearchRabbit). We have two reasons for this decision:

1. We think that this fits with colloquial usage. While the machine learning technology these tools are built on is widespread, we're unlikely to describe things like spell-checkers or social media feeds as "AI."
2. Tools that can produce human-like outputs raise a distinct set of questions about how (or whether) they ought to be used by students, questions that call for syllabus language to clarify expectations.

It follows from this definition that there are a wide variety of things that count as "using AI." Students might use different tools, they might use those tools for different purposes, and they might combine the outputs of those tools with their own efforts in different ways and to different degrees. As a result, there is no single AI policy that we feel justified in recommending. Instead, we are providing a range of options that illustrate different approaches one might take toward one's students' use of AI. Some examples are quite restrictive, others draw principled lines between different kinds of uses, and some make learning to use AI responsibly and effectively part of the content of the class.

As you decide on your own policy, we recommend that you consider two guiding questions:

- **First, ask yourself: which uses of AI are compatible with the learning goals I have for my students?** For example, imagine that you ask students to complete lab reports in order to demonstrate their understanding of the concepts relevant to the experiments they conducted during lab. If so, students using AI to produce explanations of the relevant concepts seems incompatible with the point of the lab reports, while using AI to correct grammar or get feedback on the clarity of their writing might not be.

- **Second, ask yourself: am I in a position to guide students in applying this policy?** For example, if you would like students to be sensitive to the possibility that AI will produce incorrect or misleading outputs, it can help to prepare students by discussing how and why this happens. Answering each of these questions might require some looking outward (e.g. to what various AI tools can do) and looking inward (e.g. to what your goals for particular assignments really are).

Sample Syllabus Language

Use To Be Determined [*This syllabus statement is useful when you will be determining parameters with your students in a collaborative fashion. Adjust this statement to reflect your particular plan for co-creation implementation.]*

It's important to me that we be on the same page about what kinds of uses of AI are okay in the context of this class and that you have a say in the process. So, we'll decide on our course policies by discussing them in class. Together, we'll think about the purpose of the class assignments and activities, and which uses of AI are compatible with those purposes. Once we've settled on a policy, I'll update this syllabus to include it.

Use Encouraged and Permitted [*This syllabus statement is useful when allowing, even encouraging, the broad use of generative AI tools. Adjust this statement to reflect your particular parameters of acceptable use.]*

You are welcome to use generative AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Dall-e, etc.) in this class as doing so aligns with the course learning goal *[insert the course learning goal use of AI aligns with]*. Students are expected to leverage these tools to assist with coursework, enhance their projects, and explore new ways of thinking (e.g., to help with brainstorming or to see what a completed essay might look like). I also welcome you to use AI tools to help revise and edit your work (e.g., to help identify flaws in reasoning, spot confusing or underdeveloped paragraphs, or simply fix citations). Your use of AI tools must be properly documented and cited (**See note below**).

Remember that AI may not generate a quality or accurate response, however, collaboration between human and machine intelligence is a valuable skill in the iterative learning process.

**Note, insert one of the following per your preferred citation style method:*

- How to cite generative AI output (MLA)
- How to cite generative AI output (APA)
- How to cite generative AI output (Chicago)

Use Permitted Occasionally [*This syllabus statement is useful when allowing the use of generative AI tools for some assignments and at variable levels. Adjust this statement to reflect your particular parameters of acceptable use.]*

In this course, we recognize the wide availability and access to various types of AI-based tools. These tools have many useful applications for aiding student learning. Moreover, AI-based applications will be an increasing part of industry, science, business, and the arts and students should have the opportunity to use these tools in relevant situations. On the other hand, AI involvement in student work can interfere with the genuine and authentic assessment of student learning in some situations. Therefore, it is necessary to place some limits on the use of AI-based applications in this course.

All assignments in the course will have an indication of the level of AI involvement or use that is allowable. This indication will be clearly stated verbally and in print as part of each assignment. Violation of any restrictions on the use of AI-based tools or applications will be treated as a violation of academic integrity and will be sanctioned accordingly.

AI usage in this course will fall into four broad categories –

1. No limitations – AI tools may be used in any way the student sees as useful or appropriate. AI usage should be noted and cited according to established citation standards. However, use of any AI tool is not required.
2. Specific limitations – AI tools may be used in some aspects of an assignment. These specific cases or tasks will be spelled out in the instructions to the assignment.
3. No AI usage in any form – AI tool or application use is prohibited in this assignment.
4. AI use is required – In these assignments, use of AI tools is the focus of the assignment and their effective use is part of the assignment objectives. If use of a specific AI tool or application is required, access instructions and links will be provided as part of the assignment.

Each assignment will have an explicit indication of which level of AI usage is applicable. Alternatively, an entire class of assignments (i.e. quizzes) might be given a uniform level of AI usage that is applicable in all instances. Any assignment instructions which prohibit the use of ANY outside resources or help shall be understood to be including AI resources in this general prohibition.

Use Permitted Occasionally [*This syllabus statement is useful when allowing the use of generative AI tools for some assignments and at variable levels. Adjust this statement to reflect your particular parameters of acceptable use.]*

The use of generative AI in academic work is a both an important opportunity and an area for caution. New AI tools like ChatGPT can be an amazing assist much like a calculator is for math classes. The best way to use it for idea generation, synthesis, rephrasing, essentializing and gathering information about the typical understanding of a topic.

For this course, if you choose to use it in your work and the assignment permits it, document and acknowledge how you are using it. For example:

> I used Chat-GPT 4 to generate ideas for refinement around my selected research topic. I used Elicit to find relevant papers for my literature review and to summarize key ideas in from many papers, as an enhanced Abstract. I then selected some papers to read in depth and summarize on my own. I used the Grammar checker, ProWriting Aid, which suggested revisions to some awkward sentences. I used some of these suggestions, though not all. Finally, I used Claude to suggest edits to my final paper for clarity and logic, much as I would use the professional editor, the program suggests students use. My first and second drafts are all my own work, and the ideas are all mine, except where literature sources are cited in accordance with APA guidelines. I followed the APA Style

Blog's guidance on citing AI-assisted writing (apastyle.apa.org/blog/how-to-cite-chatgpt).

However, it should be you that guides, verifies, and crafts your ultimate answers, so please don't just cut and paste without understanding. As with any assistance in completing an assignment, including friends, family, previously published material, course assistance website, follow a prudent and ethical course in using and acknowledging AI-assistance. Remember that generative AI is sometimes wrong and that you are always fully responsible for your work.

Let's leverage the tools as an extension of ourselves with a base of knowledge to make them powerful.

Use Not Permitted [*This syllabus statement is useful when no use of generative AI tools is allowed in the course. Adjust this statement to reflect your particular parameters as needed.]*

I know that it can be tempting to use AI tools when we are rushed or frustrated. However, an essential goal of this course is for you to [fill in outcome/s]. If AI completes the work for you, you will not develop the knowledge and skills necessary to [fill in knowledge, skills, attitudes]. Additionally, AI involvement in student work can interfere with the genuine and authentic assessment of student learning in some situations. To that end, I expect that any work submitted for a grade is completed by you. The use of Generative AI to complete any graded work will be considered academic dishonesty. See university policies on the honor code and the Tiger Lore Student Code of Conduct for more information about academic integrity. If you have questions, please contact me.

Conclusion

The examples above illustrate a range of options, but they're not exhaustive. If you'd like to see a what a wide range of other faculty have done, we recommend checking out this crowdsource document organized by Lance Eton of UMass. https://bit.ly/AI-Syllabi

Choosing your AI policy is just one of several related choices you'll make when designing your course. We close this document with a few suggestions about some of those other choices.

First, Any course policy, related to AI or not, works best when students appreciate the reasons for it. So, whichever kind of policy you choose, we recommend that you discuss your decision with your students. Taking time to answer their questions and showing genuine consideration for their concerns will help to build trust around these issues.

Second, we recommend that you consider how you will address situations in which you suspect that a student has violated your policy. One question is whether to use an AI detection tool. As of this writing, these tools are not reliably accurate. Moreover, the kinds of mistakes they make are distributed in inequitable ways. One problem is that students who can afford the paid versions of AI tools are more likely to avoid detection. So, the brunt of enforcement tends to

fall on less advantaged students. Another problem is that detection software is more likely to falsely flag a student's authentic prose as AI-generated when that student is not a native speaker of the language they're writing in. So, the brunt of false accusations also tends to fall on less advantaged students. **In light of these concerns, we recommend not using AI detection software.**

Whatever you decide, it's also worth considering what the next steps will be if you have reason to believe that a student has violated your policy. Will students have an opportunity to resubmit or discuss the matter with you? Will you treat violations of this policy like cases of plagiarism, or perhaps like cases where a student submits work that doesn't meet the specifications in the assignment? These questions interact with the one about detection: the more punitive the policy, the higher the stakes for false positives.

Finally, it's helpful to consider how your AI policy fits in with the other ways you motivate students to do the work required by your class. Students will feel less tempted to use AI in inappropriate ways when they see value in the work you're asking them to do, when they believe that they are capable of doing that work, and when they know how to direct their effort in order to improve. The more you can do to create an environment that reinforces these beliefs, the less worried you need to be about violations of your AI policy.

The examples above were drafted by (listed alphabetically) Leslie Bayers, Cory Davia, Fred Estes, Michele Gibney, and Andy Lloyd. While developing them, we aimed to reflect the consensus of the AI and Pedagogy Community of Practice, a working group organized by the Library and the Center for Teaching and Learning. That group – co-facilitated by Cory Davia, Michele Gibney, and Nicole Mountjoy – aims to provide faculty a space to learn about AI and discuss its implications for their research and teaching. Those conversations are ongoing. In a similar spirit, we hope that your own thinking about AI and what place it has in your courses continues to develop as the underlying technology changes, as you get familiar with the capabilities and limitations of various AI tools, and as you reflect on your goals for your students and your students' goals for themselves. We intend the considerations here as a place to start.